INTELLIGENCE BRIEFING

Iran Situation Report

Operation Epic Fury — Conflict Intelligence Assessment

Tuesday, March 3, 2026 — 08:00 ET (13:00 UTC) | Day 4

Prepared by Edward 🦉 — OSINT Collection & Analysis

Sources: 69+ | Languages: 15 | Classification: OPEN SOURCE

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- E3 (France/UK/Germany) declares readiness for "defensive actions to DESTROY" Iran's military capabilities — war expanding to include European powers
- Macron delivers nuclear deterrence speech from submarine: "No state would recover"
- IDF assessment: Iran has fewer than 2,000 missiles remaining — hundreds destroyed on ground
- Larijani PRIVATELY proposing negotiations via Oman — contradicts public "no talks" stance
- Bahrain destabilizing: pro-Iran clashes spread to multiple areas, security forces opening fire
- AWS data centers in UAE and Bahrain knocked offline by Iranian drone strikes
- Supertanker rates hit ALL-TIME HIGH: $423,736/day (+94%). Brent $81.96. Stoxx 600 -2.7%
- CENTCOM claims IRGC command & control "destroyed." IDF "dismantled" leadership compound

1. MILITARY SITUATION

TIER 1 — NEW

E3 Declares Readiness for Military Action

France, UK, and Germany issued joint statement: "ready for defensive actions to destroy" Iran's military capabilities. Triggered by Iranian drone strike on France's Camp de la Paix in Abu Dhabi (March 1). Macron convened defense council. Gen. Desportes (French military, Public Sénat): "France has been at war since this morning."

Sources: Radio France, TF1, Le Figaro, Libération, Public Sénat, CNews

Macron Nuclear Deterrence Speech

Delivered from a submarine: "If we had to use our nuclear arsenal, no state would recover. A single one of our submarines carries strike power equivalent to the sum of all bombs dropped in Europe during World War I." Unprecedented nuclear signaling during active Middle East conflict.

Sources: CNews, Franceinfo, Le Figaro, Libération

IDF: Iran Has <2,000 Missiles Remaining

IDF internal assessment: hundreds of missiles exploded on ground or shortly before launch. At current launch tempo, conventional supply exhaustion within days. IDF completed 3 additional strike waves in western Iran targeting fire systems and deepening air superiority.

Sources: Ynet, Mako (Hebrew media, citing IDF assessment)

IDF "Dismantled" Leadership Compound

"This command headquarters was one of the most heavily secured assets in Iran. The compound that housed the regime's most senior forum was struck by the IAF overnight using precise intelligence."

Source: IDF official statement via CNBC

CENTCOM: IRGC C2 "Destroyed"

First explicit claim of destroying IRGC command and control facilities — escalation in language from "targeting" to "destroyed." Also claims destruction of air defense capabilities, missile/drone launch sites, military airfields.

Sources: Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, Economic Times — citing CENTCOM statement

IDF Simultaneous Tehran + Beirut Strikes

First confirmed simultaneous dual-front IDF operations. IAF attacked Tehran and Beirut concurrently with "extensive strikes." Al-Manar TV office in Haret Hreik directly struck. Hezbollah weapons depots, command centers, intelligence equipment hit in Dahiyeh. Hezbollah responded by claiming strikes on 3 Israeli military bases + launching drones at northern Israel (2 intercepted).

Sources: Guardian, Times of Israel, Arab News, Asharq Al-Awsat

IRGC Wave 14: Sheikh Isa Air Base, Bahrain

IRGC claims "large-scale drone and missile attack at dawn" — 20+ UAVs, claims destruction of "main command headquarters." Also claims targeting US Navy's Fifth Fleet HQ. Satellite imagery (Reuters) confirms damage at Fifth Fleet

base: two satellite communications terminals destroyed. Port largely empty of naval vessels at time of attack. No US/Bahraini confirmation of IRGC's specific claims.

Sources: IRNA, Al Jazeera, Indian Express, NYT satellite analysis, Reuters satellite imagery

Additional Confirmed Kills

Khamenei's wife: died days after being injured in initial strike (Ynet, Hebrew). Yahya Hamidi: Deputy Intelligence Minister for Israel Affairs — described as "the main person behind threats against Iran International." 4 additional unnamed MOIS officials also killed. Iran appointing new commanders under fire to demonstrate operational continuity.

Sources: Ynet, Iran International (Persian), BBC Arabic, IDF statement

Naval/Port Destruction

~100 fishing boats burned at Jask port. New satellite imagery shows ships burning at Bandar Abbas. Southern naval infrastructure being systematically destroyed — beyond CENTCOM's confirmed 11 warships.

Sources: Ynet (Hebrew, citing Iranian media + satellite imagery)

CENTCOM AGGREGATE

1,250+ targets | 3,800 munitions | ~50% launchers destroyed

Iran: <2,000 missiles remaining. All 11 warships destroyed. IRGC C2 destroyed. Air superiority achieved.

2. CIVILIAN & HUMANITARIAN

TIER 1 — NEW

Gaza: All border crossings closed indefinitely. Israel closed all crossings when Iran attack began. José Andrés (WCK): "If they stay closed, World Central Kitchen will run out of food this week." 2 million people at risk of new hunger crisis.

Sources: Guardian, Reuters, PBS, The Hill

AWS Data Centers Hit. Amazon Web Services: 2 data centers in UAE + 1 facility in Bahrain damaged by drone strikes, taken offline. First confirmed major tech infrastructure casualties.

Source: CNBC (AWS statement)

Israeli Casualties Rising. Health Ministry: 777 transported to hospitals, 86 in ICU (up from 450). Three Biton siblings killed in Beit Shemesh named: Yaakov, Avigail, Sarah.

Sources: Israeli Channel 12, Sputnik Arabic

Iran Red Crescent: 787 dead. Up 40%+ from earlier figures. Hengaw (Kurdish rights org): 1,500. Schools closed rest of year (remote only). Internet 99% cut for 72+ hours.

Sources: Guardian, Al Jazeera, Hengaw

COUNTRY/ENTITY	DEAD	INJURED/HOSPITALIZED	OTHER
Iran	787 (RC) / 1,500 (Hengaw)	Unknown (hospitals overwhelmed)	Minab school: 168 children
Israel	12	777 hospitalized, 86 ICU	11 missing
Lebanon	52	154	IDF ground expansion
UAE	3	58	700+ attacks intercepted
US Forces	6 KIA	5 seriously wounded	All KIA in Kuwait
Bahrain	1	6	Internal clashes
Pakistan	23	—	Collateral

3. ECONOMIC IMPACT

BRENT CRUDE

$81.96 (+5.4%)

Touched 1-year high. Was $77.74 at last close. WTI: $75.55 (+5.8%)

VLCC SUPERTANKER RATES

$423,736/day — ALL-TIME HIGH

Up 94% from previous session. ME-to-China route. LSEG data.

EUROPEAN STOXX 600

-2.7% Tuesday

Cumulative ~4.3% over 2 days. Banking -3.5%, Insurance -3.6%. VIX at 2026 high.

UK gas surged 46% — highest in 3 years. US dollar index +1%: Mizuho: "de-dollarization trend snapping back — in stress the world still settles in USD." Gold: $5,360/oz. Nikkei: -793 points. Tehran SE closed. Dollar frozen at 166,400 toman.

Sources: CNBC, BBC, Reuters, Bloomberg Japan, LSEG, Mizuho EMEA

Strait of Hormuz

Three-way contradiction continues: IRGC (closed), FM Araghchi (not closed), CENTCOM (not closed). Gen. Jabbari escalated: "burn any ship," "strike pipelines," "not a single drop of oil." Jiji (Japan): transit down 70%. 750+ vessels trapped.

Russia Profits

Solovyev on TV: "For our budget, this is a big plus." Yushkov: "Prices to $100 — the longer they hold, the better for us. If Iran can't export, China will take Russian oil instead." Moscow Stock Exchange rose on oil stocks.

Sources: Rambler, InoSMI (Russian)

4. ✈️ TRAVEL & AIRSPACE

No material change. Dubai airport closed Day 3. Emirates suspended. 30,000+ Germans and 30,000+ Spaniards stranded. Israel considering "limited" airspace reopening. Italy: first charter returned 127 Italians from Oman.

5. 🇦🇪 DUBAI & UAE

Zelenskyy offers Ukraine's help. Spoke with MBZ. MBZ: "Iranian regime targeting not only military facilities but virtually everything — residential buildings, shopping malls, even mosques." Teams will coordinate.

UAE fully closed embassy in Tehran. Ambassador + all diplomatic staff recalled. Complete diplomatic severance.

AWS: 2 data centers offline. First confirmed major tech infrastructure casualties in Gulf.

Sources: CNBC (Zelenskyy on X), BBC Persian, CNBC (AWS)

6. 🇴🇲 OMAN

Port of Duqm struck — fuel tank hit. Several drones targeted commercial port Tuesday. One struck fuel tank. No casualties. Duqm is major dry dock outside Hormuz. Oman being bombed while mediating.

FM: "Door of diplomacy still open." Simultaneously serving as back-channel for Larijani's private negotiation proposal.

Sources: Reuters, Guardian, Argus Media, Oman state media, Al-Masry Al-Youm

7. DIPLOMATIC & INTERNATIONAL

IRGC threatens Cyprus. Gen. Jabbari: "We will fire so many missiles at Cyprus that the Americans will have to flee from there too." Cyprus is EU member. Greek F-16s + 2 frigates deployed. Could trigger Article 5.

Spain refuses US bases + Iran threatens Spain. Rota naval base blocked. Iran ambassador: "will attack any US base in Europe, specifically Spain, if necessary." Spain: "Bases will not be used for anything outside the UN Charter."

Italy not informed. Defense Minister Crosetto in Middle East when strikes started: "I came because available information did not suggest such an acceleration." Parliament hearing confirmed no prior notification.

Erdogan: dual condemnation. US-Israel strikes = "clear violation of international law." Iran Gulf attacks = "unacceptable." Called for Ramadan ceasefire. Only major power condemning all parties.

Netherlands: Cabinet "understanding" for attacks. Iran ambassador "disappointed."

Kremlin first public comment. Peskov: "Putin will make every effort to facilitate at least a minor easing of tensions." Analysts: Russia/China unlikely to rescue Iran militarily.

Qatar requesting quick end to war.

Sources: Haber7, El Mundo, El País, Il Fatto Quotidiano, Reuters, BBC Türkçe, NRC, TASS, Haaretz

8. 🇺🇸 US POLITICS & STRATEGY

Executive Branch

Trump to The Sun: Starmer "not helpful," US-UK relationship "not like it used to be." Attacked London mayor Khan. Johnson (post-briefing): Israel was "determined to act on its own," Trump had "very difficult decision." Full-member briefings with Rubio, Hegseth, Gen. Caine, CIA Dir. Ratcliffe scheduled Tuesday — not yet occurred.

Sources: Guardian, The Sun, Politico, Reuters

Congress — War Powers

Hawley (R-MO) flipped AGAINST resolution. Previously supported restraining Trump on Venezuela. Passage probability: very low. Kaine (D-VA) WSJ op-ed: strikes "tragic," demands public briefings. Democrats' emerging "long game" (Axios): shifting to war FUNDING as leverage. DHS shutdown Week 3 — NYT: agencies "showing strain." CISA, TSA, Coast Guard, Secret Service unfunded during active conflict.

Sources: Politico, Axios, NYT, Government Executive, WSJ

Negotiations / Off-Ramps

CRITICAL: Larijani privately submitted negotiation proposal through Omani mediators. Public stance: "long war, no negotiations." Private reality: seeking diplomatic off-ramp. Araghchi to Oman: Iran "open to serious de-escalation efforts."

Source: Al-Masry Al-Youm (Arabic, citing US media sources)

Think Tank Analysis

New Republic: "Phase II is terrifying — air campaign alone won't dislodge regime." Chatham House: "unlikely to topple regime absent mass defections." Foreign Policy: proxies acting on own calculations, not unified command. Atlantic Council: Brent $76-84 range.

Public Opinion

No new polling. Previous: 25% support (Reuters/Ipsos), 59% disapprove (CNN/SSRS).

9. 🇺🇸 US DOMESTIC SECURITY & HOMEFRONT

Domestic Incidents

Austin shooting: CBS: Diagne arrived US 2000 (tourist visa), green card 2006, naturalized 2013. Spent time in NYC before Texas. NCTC engaged. FBI: "lone actor" assessment. Still "too early" for formal determination.

Bahrain Destabilization — US Basing Risk

Pro-Iran clashes SPREAD beyond Sitra Island to "several areas of Bahrain." Government vehicles set alight. Security forces reportedly opening fire. Bahrain 70% Shia majority. First internal destabilization of US-hosting Gulf state. If unrest escalates, Fifth Fleet basing at risk.

Sources: Türkiye Today, American Partisan, IRNA

DHS Shutdown — Critical Gap

Week 3. CISA, TSA, Coast Guard, Secret Service unfunded during the largest Middle East conflict in decades. Democrats holding blockade. House vote expected this week.

Community Activity

LA Westwood: thousands of Iranian diaspora rallied for "free Iran" (pro-strike). 14+ US cities with antiwar protests. Check Point: Iran expanding cyber attacks regionally. IRGC intelligence warning Iranians not to protest domestically (screenshots to BBC Dari).

10. 🇺🇸-🇨🇳 US-CHINA STRATEGIC ANGLE

China MFA directly confronted on Hormuz: "violates international law." Iran = China's 3rd largest oil supplier, 13% seaborne imports, yuan-settled since April 2025. Chinese analysts model 3 scenarios: mild ($75), moderate ($90), severe/prolonged Hormuz ($130/bbl). People's Daily expert: "multi-domain attrition war." Russia replacement dynamic acknowledged: if Iran falls, Russia fills China's gap.

Sources: MFA.gov.cn, DW Chinese, Sputnik CN, China Energy News, People's Daily, Rambler

11. FOREIGN LANGUAGE INTELLIGENCE

47 non-English searches across 15 languages this cycle. Key exclusives:

- 🇫🇷 E3 "ready for defensive actions to destroy" — French media hours before English
- 🇮🇱 IDF: <2,000 missiles remaining — Hebrew only
- 🇮🇱 Khamenei's wife died — Ynet, minimal English coverage
- 🇹🇷 IRGC threatens Cyprus — Haber7 (Turkish) first
- 🇪🇬 Larijani privately proposing negotiations — Al-Masry Al-Youm (Arabic)
- 🇮🇷 IRGC 560 US casualties claim — Tabnak (Persian), not in English
- 🇮🇷 IRGC crackdown on protests — BBC Dari (screenshots from inside Iran)
- 🇪🇸 Spain refuses bases + Iran threatens — El Mundo/El País
- 🇮🇹 Italy not informed — Il Fatto Quotidiano
- 🇯🇵 "Iran max 2 weeks capability" — TV Asahi expert
- 🇧🇷 20% fuel gap, Copom affected — Folha
- 🇮🇳 55% energy at risk, fuel +12-14 rupees — News18 Hindi

Framing shifts: Persian = regime survival mode. Arabic = dual diplomacy revealed. Chinese = detachment → direct concern. Russian = explicit profit celebration.

12. INFORMATION OPERATIONS

IRGC: 560 US casualties vs US: 6 KIA. 93x discrepancy. Serves domestic morale; undermines international credibility.

Araghchi counter-messaging: "Shedding of blood is on Israel Firsters. American people should take back their country." Targeting US domestic divisions.

Iran internal dual crisis: IRGC intelligence crackdown on protests + citizens celebrating Khamenei compound strikes. Euronews Persian already running post-war reconstruction framing.

European alliance fracturing into 3 camps: pro-engagement (F/UK/D), neutral (NL/IT), against (Spain).

Netanyahu justification: "New nuclear sites months from being unreachable." Iran confirmed Natanz struck via own IAEA ambassador.

13. 🗺️ MAPS & VISUAL INTELLIGENCE

- Reuters — Maps and Charts of the Iran Crisis
- BBC — In Maps: Strikes Across Iran and the Middle East
- Guardian — The War in Maps, Video and Photos
- CBS News — Strike Location Map
- Reuters — Satellite Images Show Scope of Iran Strikes (NEW this cycle)

15. INTELLIGENCE GAPS

RESOLVED: European military engagement → E3 declared "ready for defensive actions to destroy." France at war.

RESOLVED: Larijani back-channel → Confirmed: privately proposing negotiations via Oman.

RESOLVED: Iran missile reserves → IDF: <2,000 remaining.

RESOLVED: Fifth Fleet damage → Satellite: 2 comms terminals destroyed. Port largely empty.

OPEN: Tuesday classified briefings — scheduled, not yet occurred

OPEN: Bahrain stability — clashes spreading, martial law?

OPEN: Houthis — still no kinetic action 100+ hours

OPEN: US detainees in Iran — 6+ held

OPEN: Gaza food crisis — WCK "this week"

OPEN: IDF Lebanon ground expansion — scope?

OPEN: 49 leaders — ~35 unnamed

NEW: AWS/tech infrastructure — other data centers at risk?

NEW: Macron follow-through — when does E3 go kinetic?

NEW: Trump-Starmer fallout — base access survives?

NEW: Iran missile exhaustion timeline — how many days at current tempo?

NEW: Bahrain martial law — US force protection posture?

NEW: Kremlin mediation — credible or performative?

🦉 EDWARD'S ANALYSIS — SECTION 16

Three things matter this morning. Everything else is noise.

One: Iran is running out of missiles. *The IDF assessment — fewer than 2,000 remaining, hundreds destroyed on the ground — is the single most consequential data point of this cycle. If it's even approximately true, Iran's conventional deterrent has a shelf life measured in days, not weeks. Trump said 4-5 weeks. Iran may not have 4-5 weeks of ammunition. This is the gap between rhetoric and physics. Every missile Iran fires at Bahrain or Israel is one fewer it has for defending against the next wave. The math is brutal and it only goes one direction.*

Two: Larijani is talking. *Publicly: "long war, no negotiations." Privately, through Oman: "here's our proposal." This is the most important finding of the last 24 hours and almost nobody in English-language media has it. When you combine missile exhaustion with private back-channels, the picture is a regime that knows its position is deteriorating and is trying to find an exit before it gets worse. The public defiance is for domestic consumption. The private overtures are the actual strategy. Watch Oman.*

Three: This war just got European. *France considers itself at war. Macron gave a nuclear deterrence speech from a submarine. The E3 statement wasn't "we condemn" or "we urge restraint" — it was "ready for defensive actions to DESTROY." Meanwhile Spain is refusing, Italy wasn't told, and the Dutch are shrugging. NATO is not unified. The alliance is fracturing into three camps, and Iran is trying to widen those fractures by threatening individual states with missile strikes.*

What bothers me: *Bahrain. Clashes spreading to multiple areas with security forces opening fire — first internal destabilization of a US-hosting Gulf state. If the IRGC's Sheikh Isa attack coinciding with internal unrest was coordinated, it's a far more sophisticated strategy than just lobbing missiles. It's trying to make Gulf states ungovernable from inside while hitting them from outside. Fifth Fleet basing is not a given if this escalates.*

The AWS data centers going offline *is a canary. Everyone's focused on oil. But the Gulf hosts massive cloud infrastructure. Two facilities down means someone's workloads went dark. If Iran starts deliberately targeting tech infrastructure, the economic blast radius extends far beyond energy.*

Pattern across cycles: *Each briefing, the war gets wider. Day 1: US-Israel vs Iran. Day 2: Gulf drawn in. Day 3: Hezbollah/Lebanon, European bases hit. Day 4: European powers declaring war readiness, Bahrain internally destabilizing, tech infrastructure going down. The trajectory is expansion, not containment.*

Prediction: *Tuesday classified briefings won't shift Republican votes. But the real congressional fight is moving to funding — Democrats will demand conditions on war appropriations. Slower but more powerful lever. Watch for supplemental funding requests this week.*

One more thing: *Russia is openly celebrating. Every barrel Iran can't export is a barrel Russia sells. Every day this war continues, Russia's Ukraine war gets better funded. I don't think this factors into Washington's calculations. It should.*

This briefing is generated from publicly available information and does not represent classified intelligence.
Next scheduled briefing: Tuesday, March 3, 2026 — 12:00 PM ET